



More water on Moon

A new study suggests that our moon might have more water below its lunar surface than previously thought. <http://digit.in/Moonh2o>



More chip makers for AI

With the Artificial Intelligence market exploding, tech giants like Google and Microsoft are being forced to become chip makers. <http://digit.in/GoogleChip>

FEATURES

BOSE SOUNDLINK REVOLVE+

The Bose SoundLink Revolve+ comes with a host of smart features, including support for the Bose Connect app. This allows you to adjust audio settings, give the device a custom name, and even pair it with another SoundLink speaker for stereo effect. Other features include splash resistance, microUSB charging and playback, aux-in, and pairing memory for up to five Bluetooth devices.

You also get a tripod mount in case you'd need it, and all of these make the SoundLink Revolve+ the most versatile SoundLink from Bose till date. The power button acts as the battery indicator here, and also provides voice prompts for battery and device connection status.

BANG & OLUFSEN BEOPLAY A1

The BeoPlay A1 gets much fewer frills in comparison to the SoundLink Revolve+. You get standard Bluetooth and aux connectivity, a strap for slinging it on to a hook, and a USB-C port for charging. The USB-C port here is a unique addition and not many portable speakers have adopted it till date. The benefit of this port is the reversible interface that makes charging easy, and helps if your smartphone uses the USB-C interface as well.

It also gets a customisable button that allows its buyers to execute a specific function – ranging from playing a specific track to controlling the music. The function is assigned via a smartphone app. It's not as durable, but you can pair two of these for stereo audio.

PERFORMANCE

BOSE SOUNDLINK REVOLVE+

The SoundLink lineup has consistently been one of the better sounding portable speaker portfolio, and the Revolve+ further adds to it. The speaker uses passive radiator and a down-firing transducer with onboard reflectors to provide uniform, 360-firing audio. The bass performance is particularly commendable – with good clarity, depth and nicely detailed. However, the mids do sound lacking, and the slight lack of emphasis particularly affects vocals in instrument-heavy tracks. The highs are clean and bright, and fall just short of being sharp, which makes it hit the sweet spot. Soundstaging, owing to the design, is quite good, although the primary audio direction is discernible.

BANG & OLUFSEN BEOPLAY A1

This is where the B&O BeoPlay A1 outdoes the SoundLink Revolve+. The BeoPlay A1 delivers impeccable richness of tone, and produces pitch-perfect notes. The bass lines are crisp, sharp, precise and heavy, forming an impressive backbone for the entire track. The mid frequencies are supple and clear, and are well pronounced to balance the strong low frequencies. The highs, to accompany the rest of the frequency distribution, are bright, precise and well pronounced. The overall audio has rich timbre that makes it sound in line with more expensive, desktop speakers. The horizontal 360-firing grille further adds to the expansive soundstaging of the BeoPlay A1.

VALUE FOR MONEY

BOSE SOUNDLINK REVOLVE+

At ₹24,500, it is certainly quite pricey. However, you get a premium build, quirky design, good audio performance, multi-device pairing, microUSB charging and playback, and 14 hours of playback, meaning that the SoundLink Revolve+ is indeed money well spent. Further, you get the entire SoundLink ecosystem that you can connect your device with.

BANG & OLUFSEN BEOPLAY A1

The BeoPlay A1 is the better designed speaker, and is also the better performer. It delivers 24 hours of music playback, a USB-C port for charging and connectivity, and a customisable physical button. It is not a rugged speaker, but still gets our vote as the more value for money product for ₹18,000.

CONCLUSION

Both the Bose SoundLink Revolve+ and the Bang & Olufsen BeoPlay A1 have their own strengths and advantages. Bose's 360-firing speaker is the one you should buy if you want a bigger speaker that makes people form opinions based on how it looks. It sounds quite good on its own right, and the versatility of having an ecosystem of speakers to pair with for getting stereo audio is an added benefit.

However, it needs to be taken into account that the Bose SoundLink Revolve+ is a full ₹6,500 more expensive than the B&O BeoPlay A1. For a lesser price, you get better audio quality, equally good spatial audio distribution, better battery life, and a forward-oriented USB-C port that more smartphones and laptops are adapting to these days. The BeoPlay A1 ticks all the core component checkboxes, and adds exclusivity to its appeal.

The BeoPlay A1 feels even more premium than the Bose SoundLink Revolve+, and takes the cake in this premium, portable, wireless speaker face-off. **W**